

Works of art, literature, and poetry emerged during this period, true, but for the changelings trying to find a scrap of Glamour in the blighted wasteland of the American West, the era was especially bleak. The Depression segued into the second World War, and, once again, changelings found themselves pressed into service as soldiers. While propagandists on all sides tried to cast the war as a glorious expression of national pride and duty, the realities of war quenched the spark of Glamour in almost all who fought. Changelings went to battle, Undone mortals returned, little different than their haunted, shell-shocked mortal comrades.

The Resurgence

Following the second World War and the horrors inflicted on humanity, many mortals felt as if the future died on the battlefields. Though there would be a future, it took years before humanity dared to dream again. Following the postwar baby boom, dreams of rebirth and possibilities surged through the Autumn world. Television entered living rooms, allowing humanity to explore worlds beyond imagination. Europe continued to rebuild its ruined cities, and Japan regained independence after American occupation. While the 1950s had its downsides, with the beginning Cold War and fear of communism, or the Soviet Union detonating a hydrogen bomb, the decade laid groundwork for grander visions. Following the Soviet Union's successful launch of an artificial satellite towards the end of the decade, Glamour slowly trickled from the Autumn Realm back into the Dreaming, as humanity began to envision the possibilities of exploring space.

Despite the continuing wars and generational clashes of values and morals, the 1960s steadily renewed the Autumn world's connection with the Dreaming. As the space race continued to spur the two sides of the Cold War conflict, technological advancements that benefited humanity at large followed in its wake. The new generation's adherence to the ideals of being free spirits and daring to dream about a different world made it easier for Glamour to amass. Banality's grip on mortal minds eased as the space race intensified, but it required something truly extraordinary and monumental to ignite the Glamour into an explosive crescendo. On July 20, 1969, humanity witnessed the moon landing live on television, and all of the hope, fear, and wonder of the previous decade burst forth.

Across the world, all with faerie sight witnessed ancient trods manifesting on land, on sea, and in the air as the long-gone sidhe rulers returned on majestic steeds and in chariots of light and darkness. True Dreamers emerged in all corners of the world, and balefires burnt brighter than since before the Shattering. For a brief moment, everything in the world had a chimerical quality, but centuries of amassed Banality muted it and immediately closed the gateways to Arcadia.

Guided by the Dreaming, or perhaps through their own pre-arrival planning, the first generation of Arcadian sidhe forced themselves into human hosts. Mortal witnesses describe friends or family collapsing for a brief moment, then rising, confused for a short time, but brimming with confidence and an aura of regal quality. It's also true that some sidhe souls entered the Autumn



Glimmers

Despite that the gates to Arcadia closed due to the amassed Banality, the Resurgence set the return of the sidhe in motion. Whenever massive flows of Glamour occur, such as during momentous events like the fall of the Berlin wall, the overturning of apartheid in South Africa, or the election of U.S. President Barack Obama, trods briefly open to dispatch more souls into the Autumn Realm.

Kithain have made some attempts to predetermine where glimmers are going to appear, but so far none have successfully managed to use them to travel into the Dreaming.

Sidhe that return through glimmers belong to the Arcadian sidhe (p. 106). Commoners returning must serve one of the Arcadian sidhe noble houses (see Chapter Two).



world in silence and through unseen trods, and those who did inhabited the bodies of newborn babies, waiting to grow up and join the ranks of nobility as, some believe, a contingency plan if something went wrong during the return. However, no matter the chosen human body, they all belonged to someone wealthy and influential, or were members of highly-valued and powerful families in society.

Prelude to War

It didn't take long for the returned nobles to stake their claims over freeholds and territories abandoned centuries ago. Although commoners' hard work secured the existence of balefires and holdings, the Arcadians refused to give credit for such actions. Although changelings in other countries dealt with the Resurgence differently, the commoners of Concordia refused to hand anything over to those that abandoned them and left them at the mercy of Banality. Minor skirmishes, assassinations, and blackmailing grew increasingly common in Kithain society, and it didn't take long for the nobility to wield their command of the Sovereign Art (p. 223) to enforce obedience. Despite conflicts, both parties openly declared their intent to find peaceful solutions, regardless of acts of violence intended to derail such hopes.

Caught Between Two Worlds

Recognizing the haughtiness and disregard for others they once had, sidhe of Houses Liam and Scathach sensed the escalation in conflicts earlier than any other Autumn fae. Not wanting to wage war with those who they remained with during the Interregnum, nor their brethren, the houses adopted an official neutrality policy, promising to act as mediators and messengers if requested. However, this decree didn't prevent individual members of the houses to cast their allegiance with the side for which they felt an affinity.

